

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in procedural case management, deadline-critical file organisation and client communication at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Q-Legal. Proven ability to manage high volumes of documents across competing deadlines, track procedural steps accurately and communicate requirements clearly to clients and external parties. Strong legal research and written communication skills. Seeking to apply these skills in a specialist IP paralegal environment.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages a varied caseload from initial client interview through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets fixed deadlines
- Conducts detailed client interviews, establishes factual chronologies and identifies procedural and evidential issues across welfare, housing, employment, family and debt matters
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex regulatory points
- Explains procedural requirements clearly to clients, translating complex rules into practical guidance

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Became the sole junior supporting the team in the weeks before a significant procedural deadline: tracked all outstanding documents, coordinated external translation work and liaised with the client on required materials to ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines across a complex investment arbitration
- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several concurrent matters with competing deadlines, using iManage for matter records
- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking
- Reviewed documents and assisted with skeleton arguments and other court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes

Q-Legal · London**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, including children's personal data and adtech, and translated statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer rules
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and correspondence drafting; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, structured case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters